



A Curated GTA V Modlist & Guide

GTA V Legacy 1.0.3889.0 — July 2026

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Wave 0: Getting By

1. Getting By

1.1. The Premise

You've just arrived in Los Santos and the city doesn't care. Empty pockets, a cheap apartment, and a car that barely runs.

The goal is simple: survive and thrive.

1.2. Franklin Clinton

Franklin sees Los Santos as a ladder. Repo man by day, hustler by night — every job is a step up. For him, “getting by” means escaping the neighborhood that raised him. Learn the streets, build connections, and climb.

Approach: Mission-driven. Follow the main story, invest earnings in properties, build steady income.

1.3. Michael De Santa

Michael has everything and nothing. A mansion, a family that hates him, and a past he can't outrun. “Getting by” for Michael is holding it together — keeping the peace, managing the chaos, and finding purpose beyond the couch and the therapist.

Approach: Side content. Buy the cinema, the cab company, the golf course. Build a legitimate empire while the story pulls him back into crime.

1.4. Trevor Philips

Trevor lives on the fringes. Sandy Shores is his kingdom of misfits, and his version of “getting by” is raw survival — take what you need, burn what you can't carry, and never apologize.

Approach: Explore every corner of Blaine County. Build the Trevor Philips Industries empire through chaos and opportunity.

1.5. This Guide

This wave covers the vanilla GTA V experience with a light layer of quality-of-life mods. You'll learn controls, mechanics, money-making, and how to set up mods safely. Follow the waves in order — Wave 1 assumes you know what's here.

2. Before You Begin

This guide assumes you have GTA V installed and can launch it successfully in single-player.

2.1. Installing OpenIV

OpenIV is the standard mod management tool for GTA V.

1. Download the latest version from openiv.com
2. Run the installer (default settings are fine)
3. Launch OpenIV — it will scan for your GTA V installation automatically

4. Switch OpenIV to **Edit Mode** when prompted (this enables file modification)

Always back up files before editing. OpenIV can create backups automatically — use this feature.

2.2. Mod Management with OpenIV

OpenIV organizes mods through two mechanisms:

2.2.1. Mods Folder (Recommended)

OpenIV's **mods** folder creates a virtual override system:

1. In OpenIV, go to **Tools > Package Installer**
2. Set the install path to your GTA V directory
3. Most mod packages will install into `/mods/` automatically

The **mods** folder keeps the original game files untouched. To disable all mods for GTA Online, rename the **mods** folder to **mods_off**.

2.2.2. Direct .rpf Editing

Some older mods require direct editing of game archives (.rpf files). Only do this if the mod's install guide explicitly requires it. Always back up the original .rpf first.

The most common paths:

- `update/update.rpf` — DLC content, most common target
- `x64/` — Base game textures and models
- `common.rpf` — Shared data and scripts

2.3. ScriptHookV

ScriptHookV is required by almost every mod.

1. Download ScriptHookV (v3889.0, compatible with Legacy 1.0.3889.0)
2. Extract **ScriptHookV.dll** and **dinput8.dll** into your GTA V root folder
3. Download [ScriptHookVDotNet](#) if a mod requires it
4. Extract the .asi and .dll files into the same folder

Note: For game version 1.0.3258.0 and later (which includes Legacy 1.0.3889.0), use the ScriptHookVDotNet **nightly** build (v3.6.0-nightly.89 or later) — the stable v3.6.0 and v3.5.1 have a compatibility bug on newer game versions.

Verify: Launch the game. If you see the ScriptHookV loading text in the top-left corner, it's working.

2.4. ASI Mods

ASI mods use the OpenIV.asi loader:

- Copy the **.asi** file to your GTA V root folder (**not** the **mods** folder)
- ScriptHookV's **dinput8.dll** acts as the ASI loader — no extra steps needed

2.5. Safety Checklist

Run through this checklist before starting the game with new mods:

- [] Mods folder exists and is named **mods** (not **mods_off**)

- [] ScriptHookV.dll and dinput8.dll in game root
- [] All mod files installed to correct paths
- [] Backups created for any replaced .rpf files
- [] GTA Online not launched with mods active (rename the **mods** folder to **mods_off** before launching Online)

3. Wave 0: Modlist

Wave 0 is **vanilla plus**: quality-of-life, interface, and bug-fix mods only. No graphics overhauls, no new content, no gameplay changes. The foundation (OpenIV, ScriptHookV, ScriptHookVDotNet) is installed per the **Before You Begin** guide.

3.1. Mod Entry Format

Each entry shows:

- **Category:** UI / QoL / Bugfix
- **Version:** Compatible with GTA V Legacy 1.0.3889.0
- **Dependencies:** Required tools or mods
- **Install path:** Where files go
- **System Impact:** What the mod changes
- **Installation:** Special steps (if any)

3.2. Stability & QoL

These two tools prevent the most common modded-game crashes. They change nothing visually or mechanically — they only raise engine limits so the game doesn't fall over.

3.2.1. HeapAdjuster

- **Category:** QoL / stability
- **Author:** Dilapidated
- **Version:** latest (see source)
- **Dependencies:** None
- **Install path:** Game root (HeapAdjuster.asi + HeapAdjuster.ini)
- **System Impact:** Raises the memory-heap limit
- **Installation:** Copy the .asi and .ini into the GTA V root folder.

Fixes ERR_MEM_EMBEDDEDALLOC_ALLOC crashes, which happen when the game loads too many custom assets (high-poly vehicles, add-on DLC). The bundled .ini lets you raise the heap size; the default is fine for Wave 0 and only needs raising in Wave 1.

Also on [GitHub](#).

3.2.2. Packfile Limit Adjuster

- **Category:** QoL / stability
- **Version:** latest (see source)
- **Dependencies:** None
- **Install path:** Game root (.asi)
- **System Impact:** Raises the packfile (.rpf) limit
- **Installation:** Copy the .asi into the GTA V root folder.

Fixes ERR_FIL_PACK_1 crashes by raising the number of .rpf archives the game can open. Harmless in Wave 0 and required by most Wave 1 content packs.

3.3. Bug Fixes

3.3.1. Bugstar Fixes

- **Category:** Bugfix
- **Author:** Alex106
- **Version:** 7.0 (Legacy)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV (mods folder)
- **Install path:** /mods/ (via OpenIV)
- **System Impact:** Fixes long-standing engine and world bugs
- **Installation:** Install the OpenIV package into the mods folder.

A community patch collection that corrects engine glitches and broken vehicle/pedestrian/world configuration left in the base game. Keeps the vanilla experience intact while removing annoyances — no new content or balance changes.

3.4. Not included (deliberately)

- **Trainers** (Simple Trainer, Menyoo, Rampage, Enhanced Native Trainer) — the no-cheating / no-all-knowing rule excludes them from every wave.
- **Graphics overhauls** — these live in Wave 1; Wave 0 keeps the vanilla look.

3.5. User to provide

If you want a standalone HUD/UI mod that changes the interface (rather than fixing it), verify it targets Legacy 1.0.3889.0 and add it here. None are included by default because Wave 0 keeps the vanilla UI.

3.6. Carried into Wave 1

Every mod in this wave stays installed in Wave 1. Wave 1 layers graphics, content, and mechanics on top of this foundation — nothing here is removed when you migrate.

4. Gameplay Guide

4.1. Core Controls

Key	Action
WASD	Movement
Shift	Sprint (on foot) / Accelerate (vehicle)
Space	Jump / Brake
E	Interact / Enter vehicle
F	Enter/exit cover
Q	Take cover
Left click	Shoot
Right click	Aim
R	Reload
Tab	Switch weapon

M	Phone
Z	Character ability (special)

4.2. Making Money (Early Game)

4.2.1. Story Missions

The fastest money early on comes from story missions. Prioritize:

- Franklin's repo jobs (first few missions)
- Michael's early heist setup missions
- Trevor's early jobs

4.2.2. Stock Market

The LCN and BAWSAQ stock markets are tied to specific story missions. Key rule: **always check Lester's assassination missions** — complete the mission, then invest before the target stock moves. This is the single biggest money-maker in the game.

4.2.3. Side Hustles

- **Taxi work** (Franklin): Easy early cash, unlocks taxi boost
- **Tow truck** (Franklin): Available after certain missions
- **The Epsilon Program** (Michael): Tedious but lucrative
- **Strangers and Freaks**: Random encounters that pay well and unlock content

4.3. Property Investment

4.3.1. Businesses

Buyable properties unlock passive income:

- **Los Santos Customs** (various locations): Mod shop income
- **Cinema** (Michael): Story-specific
- **Cab Company** (Franklin): Story-specific
- **Smoke on the Water**: Dispensary income

4.3.2. Safehouses

Safehouses serve as save points and vehicle storage. Buy them when you have cash — they appreciate in value... in a sense.

4.4. Combat Tips

- **Headshots** are king. Take time to aim.
- **Cover** is your best friend. Don't run into open areas.
- **Use character abilities**: Franklin's bullet-time driving, Michael's slow-mo shooting, Trevor's rage mode.
- **Body armor** is available at Ammu-Nation. Buy it before heist missions.
- **Switch weapons** strategically — use SMGs indoors, rifles at range.

4.5. Vehicle Tips

- **Sell stolen cars** at Los Santos Customs (one per in-game day)
- **Upgrade the turbo and transmission** first — best performance per dollar

- **Keep a fast car and a tough car** — speed for missions, armor for chaos
- **Use Franklin's special** for tight driving sections
- **Motorcycles** weave through traffic faster than cars

Wave 1: Untold Stories

5. Untold Stories

5.1. The Premise

The story missions are done. The big scores are history. But Los Santos is deeper than the main plot reveals — hidden locations, underground economies, new territories, and entire game systems the vanilla world never shows you.

You know the city. Now discover what it hides.

5.2. What Changes

This wave introduces mods that expand the world:

- **New mechanics:** Economy systems, gang warfare, realistic needs
- **New content:** Custom missions, map extensions, vehicles, weapons
- **Graphics overhauls:** Visuals that push the RAGE engine to its limits

5.3. Requirements

Before starting Wave 1:

- Complete the main story in Wave 0
- Familiarity with OpenIV mod management
- Understanding of ScriptHookV and ASI mods
- Strong PC recommended (graphics mods are demanding)

6. Migrating from Wave 0

6.1. Backup Your Saves

Wave 1 uses many of the same save files as Wave 0, but mods can corrupt saves. Backup your save folder before installing new mods:

Documents\Rockstar Games\GTA V\Profiles\<your-profile-id>\

6.2. Building on Wave 0

Wave 1 **keeps** every Wave 0 mod — you are layering on top, not replacing:

1. Keep ScriptHookV, OpenIV, HeapAdjuster, Packfile Limit Adjuster, and Bugstar Fixes installed.
2. Add Wave 1 mods in order: graphics → content → mechanics.
3. Apply a custom gameconfig.xml (below) before heavy content packs.

Only remove a Wave 0 mod if a specific Wave 1 mod's documentation says it conflicts — none in this list do.

6.3. New Dependencies

Wave 1 mods often require additional frameworks:

Framework	Purpose
ScriptHookVDotNet	.NET-based mods

NativeUI	Custom menu interfaces
LemonUI	Alternative UI framework
MapEditor	Map/content editing
HeapAdjuster	Memory limit adjustment for heavy mods
SirenSetting Limit Adjuster	Siren limit for add-on emergency vehicles

6.4. Gameconfig.xml

Many graphics and content mods require a custom **Gameconfig.xml** to increase memory limits:

1. Download a 1.0.3889.0-compatible Gameconfig.xml
2. Install to: /mods/update/update.rpf/common/data/gameconfig.xml
3. Without this, the game crashes when loading heavy mods

7. Wave 1: Graphics Mods

Wave 1 rebuilds the look of Los Santos. A single base overhaul (VisualV) handles lighting, weather, and colour; texture packs layer on top.

7.1. Mod Entry Format

- **Category:** Graphics
- **Version:** Compatible with GTA V Legacy 1.0.3889.0
- **Dependencies:** Required tools or mods
- **Install path:** Where files go
- **System Impact:** Visual changes to environment, lighting, textures
- **Installation:** Special steps

7.2. Base Overhaul

7.2.1. VisualV

- **Category:** Graphics (lighting / weather / colour)
- **Author:** CP & rob29
- **Version:** 1.0.630 (Legacy)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV (mods folder), ScriptHookV (optional scripts)
- **Install path:** /mods/ via OpenIV package installer
- **System Impact:** Rewrites weather, lighting, colour grading, fog, clouds
- **Installation:** OpenIV → Tools → Package Installer → VisualV.oiv → install to mods folder.

The gold-standard **vanilla-plus** overhaul: weather rewritten from hundreds of real Los Angeles references, fixed colour grading, higher-quality vehicle shadows, corrected moon size and movement, improved volumetric fog and clouds, and removal of chromatic aberration and vignette. Performance-friendly by design — the look improves without tanking FPS.

Optional add-ons (ReShade/ENB presets, procedural shadows, Earth's Atmosphere, no lens flares) are bundled; enable only what you want.

7.3. Texture Packs

These stack on top of VisualV (they touch textures, not lighting).

7.3.1. LA Roads 2.0

- **Category:** Graphics (road textures)
- **Author:** CRYHD (2.0 patch by Reyser)
- **Version:** 2.0 (latest)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV (mods folder)
- **Install path:** /mods/ (OpenIV)
- **System Impact:** Replaces road surfaces with high-quality Los Angeles textures
- **Installation:** Install via OpenIV; enable in `dlclist.xml` if distributed as an add-on.

High-resolution, real Los Angeles-style road surfaces. The single biggest visual upgrade for street-level driving. Distributed on GTA5-Mods.com.

7.3.2. Real California Architecture

- **Category:** Graphics (signage / landmarks)
- **Author:** RCA (add-on maintained by Reyser)
- **Version:** latest (WIP)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV (mods folder)
- **Install path:** /mods/ (OpenIV)
- **System Impact:** Adds real-world California signage and landmarks
- **Installation:** Install via OpenIV; a work-in-progress, so read its compatibility notes before combining with other map edits.

Adds realistic freeway signs, the Hollywood sign, and other iconic Los Angeles landmarks. Distributed on GTA5-Mods.com as a work-in-progress — combine carefully with other map or graphics mods.

7.3.3. Real | RAGE V - 4K Water Overhaul

- **Category:** Graphics (water textures)
- **Author:** Real_Gabe
- **Version:** latest (see source)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV (mods folder)
- **Install path:** /mods/ (OpenIV)
- **System Impact:** Replaces water textures with 4K versions
- **Installation:** Install via OpenIV; check the page's comments for current-build compatibility.

High-resolution water textures with custom caustics and foam, making shorelines and shallow water look far more realistic. Stacks with VisualV — it only replaces `water.ytd`.

7.4. Alternative (not selected)

7.4.1. NaturalVision Evolved (NVE)

- **Status:** Not adopted
- **Author:** Razed (Razed Mods)
- **Reason:** Photorealistic overhaul distributed through Patreon; conflicts with VisualV (both rewrite lighting, weather, and textures). A premium alternative if you want photo-realism instead of vanilla-plus — but do not install it alongside VisualV.

7.4.2. QuantV

- **Status:** Not adopted
- **Reason:** Another industry-leading lighting/weather overhaul, distributed through its own channels. Same conflict class as NVE — rewrites lighting and weather, so choose at most one overhaul.

7.5. User to provide

Slot for additional texture packs (vegetation, water, particle effects). Verify each targets Legacy 1.0.3889.0.

8. Wave 1: Content Mods

New vehicles, unlocked interiors, and a more varied street population. Content packs use the add-on DLC method, so install the custom `gameconfig.xml` (see the migration guide) before anything else here.

8.1. Mod Entry Format

- **Category:** Content
- **Version:** Compatible with GTA V Legacy 1.0.3889.0
- **Dependencies:** Required tools or mods
- **Install path:** Where files go
- **System Impact:** What it adds
- **Installation:** Special steps

8.2. Vehicles

8.2.1. IVPack

- **Category:** Content (vehicles, add-on)
- **Author:** CP
- **Version:** 1.0.280
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV, custom `gameconfig.xml`, Packfile Limit Adjuster
- **Install path:** `/mods/update/x64/dlcpacks/` + `dlclist.xml` entry
- **System Impact:** Adds GTA IV vehicles as add-on DLC
- **Installation:** Install the add-on via OpenIV; add it to `dlclist.xml`.

Brings a lore-friendly fleet of GTA IV vehicles (cars, bikes, SUVs, trucks, emergency, taxi) into Los Santos without replacing vanilla cars — a clean add-on that coexists with the base traffic.

8.2.2. VanillaWorks Extended Pack

- **Category:** Content (vehicles, add-on)
- **Author:** VanillaWorks & other modders
- **Version:** latest (see source)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV, custom `gameconfig.xml`, HeapAdjuster, Packfile Limit Adjuster, SirenSetting Limit Adjuster
- **Install path:** `/mods/update/x64/dlcpacks/` + `dlclist.xml` entry
- **System Impact:** Adds a large lore-friendly vehicle fleet with tuning and liveries
- **Installation:** Install the OpenIV package; add it to `dlclist.xml`.

A community-built lore-friendly vehicle expansion: a large fleet of fictional-brand cars, tuning options, and liveries that blend into the base game's world. A “heavy” add-on — keep the SirenSetting Limit Adjuster installed alongside the other limit adjusters to avoid crashes.

8.3. Interiors

8.3.1. Enable All Interiors

- **Category:** Content (interiors)
- **Author:** HKH191
- **Version:** latest (WIP)
- **Dependencies:** ScriptHookV, ScriptHookVDotNet
- **Install path:** /scripts/ (ScriptHookVDotNet)
- **System Impact:** Unlocks interiors normally closed in singleplayer
- **Installation:** Drop the script into /scripts/.

Unlocks interiors that the base game keeps locked (police stations, hospitals, stores, and other buildings), letting you move through spaces the vanilla world only hints at. A work-in-progress — check the page for current-build compatibility.

8.4. Traffic & Population

8.4.1. Dispatch of Variety

- **Category:** Content (population / traffic)
- **Version:** latest (see source)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV (mods folder)
- **Install path:** /mods/ (OpenIV)
- **System Impact:** Diversifies pedestrian and vehicle spawning
- **Installation:** Install via OpenIV.

Adds variety to the pedestrians and vehicles that populate the streets — a maintained alternative to the older **World of Variety**.

8.5. Not included (deliberately)

8.5.1. World of Variety (WoV)

- **Status:** Rejected
- **Author:** Cass
- **Reason:** Deprecated/outdated for current builds and conflicts with add-on vehicle packs (both edit popgroups.ymt, popcycle.dat, and vehiclemodelsets.meta). **Dispatch of Variety** covers the same ground while being maintained.

8.5.2. LA Revo 2.0

- **Status:** Not adopted (alternative)
- **Author:** Adnr Studio
- **Reason:** All-in-one map + graphics overhaul distributed through Patreon. Replaces roads, buildings, signage, vegetation, and lighting wholesale, so it conflicts with the curated graphics/content stack (VisualV, LA Roads, Real California Architecture, IVPack). A premium choice if you want a single “real Los Angeles” overhaul instead of this list — but not alongside it.

8.6. User to provide

Slot for mission packs and large map additions. Verify each targets Legacy 1.0.3889.0 and uses the add-on DLC method.

9. Wave 1: Mechanics Mods

These mods deepen driving, fuel management, and police response. All require ScriptHookV.

9.1. Mod Entry Format

- **Category:** Mechanics
- **Version:** Compatible with GTA V Legacy 1.0.3889.0
- **Dependencies:** Required tools or mods
- **Install path:** Where files go
- **System Impact:** What gameplay system changes
- **Installation:** Special steps

9.2. Driving

9.2.1. Drive V

- **Category:** Mechanics (vehicle handling / damage)
- **Author:** PermissionToLand
- **Version:** latest (see source)
- **Dependencies:** ScriptHookV
- **Install path:** Game root (.asi / scripts)
- **System Impact:** Realistic handling, deformation, and damage
- **Installation:** Install per the page's instructions (script + handling files).

The actively maintained successor to **Realistic Driving V** (abandoned in 2018). Replaces vanilla vehicle handling with realistic physics — weight transfer, reduced grip, and much more punishing deformation. Makes every crash and getaway feel earned.

9.2.2. Manual Transmission

- **Category:** Mechanics (driving)
- **Author:** ikt
- **Version:** latest (see source)
- **Dependencies:** ScriptHookV
- **Install path:** Game root (Gears.asi)
- **System Impact:** Full manual transmission, clutch, wheel support
- **Installation:** Copy Gears.asi to the root; configure in the in-game menu.

Adds manual sequential and H-pattern shifting with a working clutch, plus steering-wheel support (DirectInput + force feedback), launch control, and traction/stability control. Development has moved to the author's Patreon; the GTA5-Mods download remains the install point.

9.3. Survival

9.3.1. Simple Fuel

- **Category:** Mechanics (economy / survival)
- **Author:** LeFix
- **Version:** 1.1.7 (+ community patches)
- **Dependencies:** ScriptHookV, ScriptHookVDotNet
- **Install path:** /scripts/ (ScriptHookVDotNet)
- **System Impact:** Fuel consumption and refuelling
- **Installation:** Drop the script into /scripts/; configure via the .ini.

Vehicles consume fuel, and you must refuel at stations or with jerry cans — running out strands you on the roadside. The original 1.1.7 is unmaintained; if it errors on current builds, use the community patches (1.1.8/1.1.9) linked in the page's comments.

9.4. Police & Emergency

9.4.1. Rebalanced Dispatch Enhanced (RDE)

- **Category:** Mechanics (police / emergency services)
- **Author:** Yard1 & team (rebalanced community release)
- **Version:** 4.1.2+ (see source)
- **Dependencies:** OpenIV (mods folder), ScriptHookVDotNet
- **Install path:** /mods/ (OpenIV)
- **System Impact:** Overhauls police, military, and emergency dispatch
- **Installation:** Large install — follow the page's guide; use the mods folder.

The continuation of **Realism Dispatch Enhanced**: lore-friendly police/military/emergency vehicles, realistic AI and dispatch behaviour, and region-correct agencies. Requires an up-to-date gameconfig.xml, ScriptHookV, and ScriptHookVDotNet nightly.

9.5. User to provide

Slot for further mechanics mods (economy, gang systems, needs). Verify each targets Legacy 1.0.3889.0.

10. Wave 1: Adult Mods

Policy. This category is for readers 18+ only. Per project rules, adult/nude content is allowed only with explicit per-mod user approval — so nothing is included by default.

10.1. Why this section exists

The guide reserves this section so approved adult mods can be documented without forcing them on every reader.

10.2. Approval process

1. Propose a specific mod (name + source) for review.
2. Confirm it targets GTA V Legacy 1.0.3889.0 and doesn't conflict with any adopted mod.

3. On approval, it is documented here with the same entry format as the other waves.

No adult mods are currently listed.

11. Advanced Strategy Guide

11.1. Optimizing for Modded Gameplay

Heavy mods require tweaking to maintain stable FPS:

11.1.1. Memory and Performance

- Install **HeapAdjuster** or **HeapLimitAdjuster** for memory limit increases
- Use **Gameconfig.xml** tuned to your RAM (8GB/16GB/32GB variants exist)
- Set **-GPUCount** and **-availablevidmem** launch parameters in Steam/RGL
- Disable VSync in-game, cap FPS via GPU driver

11.1.2. Load Order

ASI mods load alphabetically from the root folder. If two ASI mods conflict:

1. Rename one to load later (e.g., **zzz_myMod.asi** loads last)
2. Check each mod's documentation for recommended load position

11.1.3. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely Fix
Crash on startup	Outdated ScriptHookV or missing Gameconfig.xml
Crash on loading save	Corrupted save or missing mod dependency
Textures not loading	Packfile limit reached — use HeapAdjuster
Infinite loading screen	Conflicting .rpf mods — check mods folder
FPS drops	Too many 4K textures — reduce texture quality

11.2. Hidden Content Routes

With content mods installed, explore:

- (To be documented with specific mod content)